

SEO Technical Audit Checklist

FREE RESOURCE · WEB DEVELOPMENT

SEO Technical Audit Checklist

A 30-item technical SEO audit checklist covering crawlability, indexability, page speed, structured data, mobile, and Core Web Vitals — with tool recommendations and a priority scoring guide.

30 Technical Checks

6 Audit Categories

Tool Recommendations

Priority Scoring Guide

30

checks

6

categories

6

tool sets

4

priority tiers

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Work through each category systematically rather than jumping between them — crawlability and indexability issues should be resolved before fine-tuning page speed or structured data, since a page that can't be crawled or indexed gets no benefit from those improvements. Use the priority scoring guide at the end to decide what to fix first once you've completed the audit.

Crawlability

5 checks

- 01 ☐ robots.txt exists and doesn't accidentally block important content.
- 02 ☐ XML sitemap exists, is current, and is submitted to Google Search Console.
- 03 ☐ Internal linking lets crawlers reach every important page within a few clicks.
- 04 ☐ No orphaned pages — pages with zero internal links pointing to them.
- 05 ☐ Crawl budget isn't wasted on low-value URLs (faceted navigation, duplicate parameters).

Indexability

5 checks

- 06 ☐ Important pages return a 200 status code, not 404, 301, or 500.

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- 07 ☐ Noindex tags appear only on pages intentionally excluded from search.
 - 08 ☐ Canonical tags point to the correct preferred version of each page.
 - 09 ☐ No duplicate content issues across similar or parameterised URLs.
 - 10 ☐ Pages blocked by robots.txt are not also listed in the XML sitemap.
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Page Speed

5 checks

- 11 ☐ Images are compressed and served in modern formats (WebP / AVIF).
 - 12 ☐ Server response time (TTFB) is within an acceptable range.
 - 13 ☐ Render-blocking CSS and JavaScript are minimised or deferred.
 - 14 ☐ Browser caching is configured for static assets.
 - 15 ☐ A CDN serves content from a location close to the visitor.
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Structured Data

5 checks

- 16 ☐ Schema markup is implemented for key content types (Article, Product, Organization).
 - 17 ☐ Structured data validates without errors in Google's Rich Results Test.
 - 18 ☐ Breadcrumb schema is implemented wherever breadcrumb navigation exists.
 - 19 ☐ FAQ or HowTo schema is used where the content genuinely supports it.
 - 20 ☐ Structured data accurately reflects the visible page content — no mismatched markup.
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Mobile

5 checks

- 21 ☐ Site passes Google's Mobile-Friendly Test.
 - 22 ☐ Tap targets — buttons, links — are sized and spaced appropriately for touch.
 - 23 ☐ Text is readable on mobile without the user needing to zoom.
 - 24 ☐ Mobile page speed is tested separately, never assumed to match desktop.
 - 25 ☐ Content parity exists between mobile and desktop — nothing hidden from either.
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Core Web Vitals

5 checks

- 26 ☐ Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) is under 2.5 seconds.
 - 27 ☐ Interaction to Next Paint (INP) is under 200 milliseconds.
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- 28** ☐ Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) is under 0.1.
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- 29** ☐ Core Web Vitals are checked using real field data (CrUX / Search Console), not lab data alone.
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- 30** ☐ Core Web Vitals are monitored on a recurring basis, not only once at launch.
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Tool Recommendations

Use dedicated tools rather than guessing — several of these checks are impossible to verify reliably by eye.

Category	Recommended Tools
Crawlability & Indexability	Google Search Console, Screaming Frog SEO Spider
Page Speed	Google PageSpeed Insights, GTmetrix, WebPageTest
Structured Data	Google Rich Results Test, Schema Markup Validator
Mobile	Google Mobile-Friendly Test, Chrome DevTools Device Mode
Core Web Vitals	Google Search Console (Core Web Vitals report), Chrome UX Report (CrUX)
General / All-in-One	Google Lighthouse, Ahrefs Site Audit, SEMrush Site Audit

Priority Scoring Guide

Once you've completed the audit, score each failed check by impact and effort to decide what to fix first.

IMPACT / EFFORT MATRIX

High Impact · Low Effort

Quick win. Fix immediately — these deliver the best return for the least work.

High Impact · High Effort

Major project. Plan and resource properly rather than squeezing it in.

Low Impact · Low Effort

Nice to have. Fix opportunistically when you're already in that area of the site.

Low Impact · High Effort

Deprioritise. Revisit only if priorities shift or the cost of fixing drops.

TYPICAL IMPACT BY CATEGORY

A useful starting point when you don't have time to score every individual check.

Category	Typical Impact	Why
Crawlability	Critical	If crawlers can't reach a page, nothing else on this list matters for it.
Indexability	Critical	A page that can't be indexed can't rank, regardless of its quality.
Page Speed	High	Directly affects both rankings and conversion — slow pages lose users before they convert.
Core Web Vitals	High	A direct Google ranking factor, and a strong proxy for real user experience.
Mobile	High	Google indexes mobile-first — issues here affect how the whole site is evaluated.
Structured Data	Medium	Improves how listings appear in search, but rarely blocks ranking outright on its own.

ONE FINAL NOTE

Technical SEO is not a one-time project. Re-run this checklist after any significant site change — a redesign, a migration, a new CMS — and revisit Core Web Vitals on an ongoing basis, since real-world performance can drift even when the code itself hasn't changed.